

Jamaican Jerk Chicken with Coconut Rice and Pineapple Mango Salsa

Status: Stage 1 Draft
Weekly folder: weekly-plans/2026/week-28/
Category: Chicken
Source or inspiration: Next-week family menu idea
Date added: 2026-07-04

Planning Summary

- Servings: 4
- Estimated prep time: 30 minutes, plus 30 minutes marinade time
- Estimated cook time: 35 minutes
- Protein: Chicken thighs
- Cuisine or flavor direction: Jamaican-inspired jerk, smoky, sweet, spicy, citrusy
- Best day to cook: Sunday
- Perishability notes: Uses fresh chicken, mango, pineapple, cilantro, lime, and peppers. Best early in the week.

Equipment

- Grill or grill pan
- Medium saucepan with lid
- Mixing bowls
- Cutting board and knife
- Instant-read thermometer

Ingredients

Assume nothing is on hand. Include quantities for everything used.

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
2 1/2 lb	Boneless skinless chicken thighs	Trimmed	Chicken breasts, watched carefully	Main protein
3 tbsp	Neutral oil	Avocado or canola oil	Vegetable oil	For marinade and grill
3 tbsp	Low-sodium soy sauce	Low-sodium	Tamari	Marinade
2 tbsp	Apple cider vinegar	Apple cider vinegar	White vinegar	Marinade tang
2 tbsp	Lime juice	Fresh	Bottled lime juice	About 1 lime
2 tbsp	Brown sugar	Light brown sugar	Dark brown sugar	Balances heat
4	Green onions	Fresh	1 small shallot	Rough chopped for marinade
4 cloves	Garlic	Fresh	1 tsp garlic powder	Marinade
1 tbsp	Fresh ginger	Peeled and grated	1 tsp ground ginger	Marinade

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
1	Scotch bonnet or habanero pepper	Seeded for less heat	Jalapeno	Start with half if heat-sensitive
2 tsp	Ground allspice	Ground	None	Key jerk flavor
1 tsp	Dried thyme	Dried	1 tbsp fresh thyme	Marinade
1 tsp	Smoked paprika	Smoked	Sweet paprika	Smoky flavor
1/2 tsp	Ground cinnamon	Ground	None	Marinade
1/4 tsp	Ground nutmeg	Ground	None	Marinade
1/2 tsp	Cayenne pepper	Ground	Red pepper flakes	Optional heat control
1 1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt, use less	Marinade
1/2 tsp	Black pepper	Freshly ground	Ground black pepper	Marinade
1 1/2 cups	Jasmine rice	Long-grain jasmine	Long-grain white rice	Coconut rice
1 can, 13.5 oz	Coconut milk	Full-fat canned	Light coconut milk	Coconut rice
1 1/4 cups	Water	Cold water	Low-sodium chicken broth	Coconut rice
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Coconut rice
1 tbsp	Lime juice	Fresh	Bottled lime juice	Finish rice
2 cups	Pineapple	Fresh diced	Canned pineapple chunks, drained	Salsa
1 large	Mango	Ripe but firm	Frozen mango, thawed and drained	Salsa
1	Red bell pepper	Fresh	Orange bell pepper	Salsa
1/4 cup	Red onion	Finely diced	Shallot	Salsa
1/4 cup	Cilantro	Fresh chopped	Parsley	Salsa
1	Jalapeno	Seeded and minced	Skip for mild salsa	Salsa
1 tbsp	Lime juice	Fresh	Bottled lime juice	Salsa
1/4 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Salsa

Basic Instructions

1. Blend or finely mash the marinade ingredients: oil, soy sauce, vinegar, lime juice, brown sugar, green onions, garlic, ginger, chile pepper, allspice, thyme, smoked paprika, cinnamon, nutmeg, cayenne, salt, and black pepper.
2. Coat chicken with the marinade. Refrigerate at least 30 minutes, or up to 8 hours.
3. Make the salsa by mixing pineapple, mango, bell pepper, red onion, cilantro, jalapeno, lime juice, and salt. Refrigerate until serving.
4. Rinse rice until the water runs mostly clear. Add rice, coconut milk, water, and salt to a saucepan. Bring to a simmer, cover, reduce heat to low, and cook 15 minutes. Rest covered 10 minutes, then fluff with lime juice.
5. Grill chicken over medium-high heat for 5 to 7 minutes per side, until browned and the thickest pieces reach 165 degrees F. Rest 5 minutes before slicing.
6. Serve sliced jerk chicken over coconut rice with pineapple mango salsa on top.

Notes

- What might need testing: Family heat tolerance. Start with half a Scotch bonnet or use jalapeno if needed.
 - Possible substitutions: Chicken breasts can work but may dry out faster.
 - Prep-ahead ideas: Make marinade and salsa Sunday morning. Do not add salsa salt until closer to serving if the fruit is very juicy.
 - Family preference concerns: Smoky heat may need a mild portion set aside before adding cayenne or hot pepper.
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Review Link

Review file: